The Money Rules

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📋 Executive Summary

Wealth is built not by earning more, but by keeping more and deploying it wisely. Track every financial metric, delay celebrations, plan ahead for taxes, and never abandon the habits that got you there.

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💡 The Core Wealth Principle 0:00

- **Wealth is not determined by how much money you earn**
  - It is determined by how much you *keep* and what you *do* with what you keep
  - Earning a high income without discipline leads nowhere if it is all spent

📊 Know Your Numbers 0:00

- Know exactly how much money you spend on a monthly basis
- Know how much you reinvest back into your business
- Know the full cost of your lifestyle
- Know by how much your lifestyle cost is *increasing* over time
  - Tracking lifestyle inflation is as important as tracking the lifestyle itself

⚠️ Don't Celebrate Too Soon 0:00

- The moment you have one good month, you should not immediately celebrate
  - A single strong month can tempt premature spending or lifestyle upgrades
  - Discipline in good times is what separates those who build lasting wealth from those who do not
- Allocate money early for taxes
  - Set aside tax obligations *before* spending, not after

🗓️ Plan Ahead for Obligations 0:21

- Allocate money early for commitments and expenses you already know are coming
  - Anticipated obligations should never catch you off guard financially
  - Proactive allocation prevents reactive financial stress

🏁 A Million Dollars Is Just the Beginning 0:21

- Having a million dollars in the bank is only your first stop — the game does not end there
- You must maintain the same great habits that brought you to that milestone
  - Continue those habits as you accumulate more money

> The habits that build wealth are the same habits that protect and grow it — they never become optional.